

GTM SKILLATHON

MEET THE JURY

28 AUG 2026 FROM 5:00 PM

powered by



Codex



apify

organized by



Formidable
builders

How to Web presents
BUILDERS HOUSE
powered by SCR



MIRUNA DRAGOMIR
CMO Planable



ALEX GAVRILA
CEO Promocrat



ALEX CONSTANTIN
CTO stock.estate



MARA ILIE
CEO Korena

GTM SKILLATHON • PREP SUMMARY

28 August 2026 • Builders House, București • Alex Constantin, 23 August

WHERE THINGS STAND

Everything a participant or a jury member needs now lives in two public GitHub repositories, and it has been tested end to end: a real repository created from the template, a real submission issue, the automated verdict, and the jury pipeline producing a scoreboard. The one open item on my side is sending the email below on 24 August.

PARTICIPANT TEMPLATE

formidable-oss/ gtm-skillathon-starter

Rules, build contract, two helper skills, submission validator.

SUBMISSIONS AND JURY

formidable-oss/ gtm-skillathon-submissions

Issue form, validation action, live board, jury skill, this email.

HOW THE EVENING RUNS

LOCAL	WHAT HAPPENS
17:00	Doors, check-in
17:30	Intro, how it works, how teams are judged, live Codex workflow demo
18:00	Build starts. Submissions open.

20:30	Hard cutoff. Issues opened at or after 20:30:00 are rejected by the system. Demos start straight away, random order, 2:00 per team, 2:30 hard stop.
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21:45	Formidable Builders launch party
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- Teams of one or two. Build with any agent. The judged run happens in the Codex desktop app on one organizer laptop, with no API keys and no MCP servers.
- A submission is a public GitHub repository plus a commit SHA. The organizer clones that exact commit and presents it. Teams do not present; their `DEMO.md` is the script.
- Resubmitting is allowed until the cutoff. The latest accepted submission per repository counts. Pushing after submission changes nothing.

JUDGING

Four automated gates, five scores proposed by Codex from the repository, two scores from the jury. Total out of 35. A team that fails a gate is listed but not ranked. Ties go to jury discussion.

AUTOMATED GATES	AUTOMATED SCORES (1–5, CODEX PROPOSES, JURY MAY OVERRIDE)	JURY SCORES (1–5)
Submitted in window	GTM job clarity	Presentation
Valid structure	Real-world signal (sourced, dated web data)	Vibe
Runs within 75 s from a fresh clone	Evidence (three honest eval cases)	
Clean: no secrets, no personal data, no credentials needed	Skill quality	
	Reusability	

In rehearsal the scorer fetched the live Planable pricing page, noticed that my test snapshot did not match it, and flagged the submission for suspected fabrication. That is the behaviour I wanted from the fabrication gate, and it caught me first.

WHAT I BUILT

Template repository

- `RULES.md` is the single source of truth for timeline, rules, and criteria. `README.md` and `AGENTS.md` summarize it for the participant's agent.
- `$skillathon-guide` explains the event, answers the FAQ, and walks a team to one track, one user, one narrow job, one input, one success condition, one boundary. It handles git for people who have never used it.
- `$skillathon-submit` runs the same validator the server runs, commits and pushes with the participant, files the submission, and reports the verdict.
- Deliverables per team: entry skill, seed prompt, representative input, fallback output, three evals with observed results, a run sheet for me, and `submission.json`.

Submission system, no hosted app

- A GitHub issue form. The issue timestamp is the submission time; participants cannot alter it.

- A GitHub Action checks the window, verifies the repository is public and the commit exists, clones at that SHA, runs the validator, and replies within about 20 seconds with `accepted` or `rejected` and the exact items to fix. Before 18:00 it answers `dry-run`, so teams can test the pipeline early.
- The accepted record is stored in the bot's comment, which participants cannot edit. A newer accepted issue from the same repository supersedes the old one.
- A live board with countdown for the venue screen: formidable-oss.github.io/gtm-skillathon-submissions.

Jury skill (runs from Codex on my laptop)

- `$skillathon-jury` pulls accepted submissions at their exact commits, smoke-tests every seed prompt with a 75 s cap, asks Codex to score the five criteria with a strict output schema and written rationales, draws the presentation order from a seed announced on stage, and writes the scoreboard, a per-team runbook, and an on-screen board with a 2:00 timer.
- Incremental by commit, so I can run it every 20 minutes during the build and have almost nothing left to do at 20:30.
- Jury members fill presentation and vibe in `jury/jury-scores.csv`; `report.mjs --final` ranks.

Review

Two independent review passes, one reading the template as a non-technical participant's agent, one attacking the code. 43 findings; the material ones are fixed: a GitHub rate-limit problem that would have broken under the 20:29 burst, infrastructure errors that turned into rejections, slug collisions, a board race, CSV corruption, validator false positives, and about fifteen gaps in the instructions for people who do not code.

STILL ON MY LIST BEFORE THURSDAY

- Send the [email](#) on 24 August with the jury banner attached.
- Set `model_reasoning_effort = "medium"` in Codex on the jury laptop. At "high" a small skill took 50 to 75 seconds, right at the cap.
- Rehearse once with a colleague filing a dry-run issue from their machine, then `pull.mjs --rehearsal`.
- At 20:30 on the night: disable issues on the submissions repository, run the jury pipeline one last time, draw the order.

PARTICIPANT EMAIL

To send 24 August. Banner attached.

Subject: GTM Skillathon on Thursday: agenda, jury, and a 5-minute prep

Hi,

Thursday is the GTM Skillathon. Three things.

Agenda (28 August, Builders House, AFI Park 1, floor 1, above BCR)

17:00 doors · 17:30 intro and live Codex demo · 18:00 build starts, submissions open · **20:30 hard cutoff**, demos start · 21:45 launch party

Jury: Miruna Dragomir (CMO Planable), Alex Gavril (CEO Promocrat), Alex Constantin (CTO stock.estate), Mara Ilie (CEO Korena). Banner attached.

Before you arrive: a GitHub account, git, the GitHub CLI signed in (`gh auth login`), Node.js 18 or newer, and your agent of choice (Codex, Claude Code, Cursor, anything) installed and signed in. No coding experience needed. Bring one GTM problem you actually have.

Then paste this into your agent. It will explain how the evening works, what to build, how you are judged, and help you pick a problem that fits in two and a half hours:

I am taking part in the GTM Skillathon on 28 August 2026. Read these three pages in full:

- <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/formidable-oss/gtm-skillathon-starter/main/README.md>
- <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/formidable-oss/gtm-skillathon-starter/main/RULES.md>
- <https://luma.com/82q9ac1g>

Then explain to me, plainly: how the evening runs and the timeline; what I have to build and deliver; how submission works, when it closes, and what happens if I miss it; how the organizer will present my work and how the jury scores it; and exactly what I should install or prepare before 17:00. Then ask me about my go-to-market work and suggest three narrow problems I could solve in two and a half hours, each with the input it would need and the artifact it would produce.

Template: github.com/formidable-oss/gtm-skillathon-starter · Event: luma.com/82q9ac1g

Laptop and charger. See you Thursday.

Formidable Builders · Builders House